

Unit 32: Exponential Functions — Full Solutions

Warm-up

1. $\frac{d}{dx}[e^x] = e^x$

2. $\frac{d}{dx}[e^{2x}]$

Chain rule: $u = 2x$, $u' = 2$.

$$\frac{d}{dx}[e^{2x}] = 2e^{2x}$$

3. $\frac{d}{dx}[3e^x] = 3e^x$

4. Solve $e^x = 5$.

$$x = \ln 5$$

5. $\int e^x dx = e^x + C$

6. $\frac{d}{dx}[e^x + x^2] = e^x + 2x$

Standard

7. $\frac{d}{dx}[e^{x^2}]$

Chain rule: $u = x^2$, $u' = 2x$.

$$\frac{d}{dx}[e^{x^2}] = 2xe^{x^2}$$

8. $\frac{d}{dx}[e^{3x+1}]$

Chain rule: $u = 3x + 1$, $u' = 3$.

$$\frac{d}{dx}[e^{3x+1}] = 3e^{3x+1}$$

9. $\frac{d}{dx}[xe^x]$

Product rule: $f = x$ ($f' = 1$), $g = e^x$ ($g' = e^x$).

$$\frac{d}{dx}[xe^x] = 1 \cdot e^x + x \cdot e^x = e^x(1 + x)$$

10. $\frac{d}{dx} \left[\frac{e^x}{x} \right]$

Quotient rule: $f = e^x$ ($f' = e^x$), $g = x$ ($g' = 1$).

$$\frac{d}{dx} \left[\frac{e^x}{x} \right] = \frac{e^x \cdot x - e^x \cdot 1}{x^2} = \frac{e^x(x-1)}{x^2}$$

11. Solve $e^{2x-1} = 7$.

$$2x - 1 = \ln 7$$

$$2x = \ln 7 + 1$$

$$x = \frac{\ln 7 + 1}{2}$$

12. $\int 3e^{2x} dx$

Let $u = 2x$, $du = 2 dx \Rightarrow dx = \frac{du}{2}$.

$$3 \int e^u \cdot \frac{du}{2} = \frac{3}{2} e^u + C = \frac{3}{2} e^{2x} + C$$

13. $\int_0^1 e^x dx$

$$\left[e^x \right]_0^1 = e^1 - e^0 = e - 1$$

Answer: $e - 1$.

Challenge

14. Solve $e^{3x-6} = 9$.

$$3x - 6 = \ln 9$$

$$3x = \ln 9 + 6$$

$$x = \frac{\ln 9 + 6}{3}$$

(Since $9 = 3^2$, this can also be written as $x = \frac{2\ln 3 + 6}{3} = \frac{2\ln 3}{3} + 2$.)

15. $y = (9x^2 - 6x + 2)e^{3x}$. Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$.

Product rule: $f = 9x^2 - 6x + 2$ ($f' = 18x - 6$), $g = e^{3x}$ ($g' = 3e^{3x}$).

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = (18x - 6)e^{3x} + (9x^2 - 6x + 2)(3e^{3x})$$

Factor out e^{3x} :

$$= e^{3x} \left[(18x - 6) + 3(9x^2 - 6x + 2) \right] = e^{3x} [18x - 6 + 27x^2 - 18x + 6]$$

Notice the $18x$ and $-18x$ cancel, and $-6 + 6 = 0$:

$$= e^{3x} (27x^2) = 27x^2 e^{3x}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = 27x^2 e^{3x}.$$

16. $\frac{d}{dx}[e^{\sin x}]$

Chain rule: $u = \sin x$, $u' = \cos x$.

$$\frac{d}{dx}[e^{\sin x}] = e^{\sin x} \cdot \cos x$$

17. $\int 2xe^{x^2} dx$

Let $u = x^2$, $du = 2x dx$.

$$\int e^u du = e^u + C = e^{x^2} + C$$

18. Solve $2e^x - 3 = 7$.

Isolate the exponential term first:

$$2e^x = 10$$

$$e^x = 5$$

$$x = \ln 5$$

Applied

19. $A(t) = 1000e^{0.06t} = 2000$ (doubled).

$$e^{0.06t} = 2$$

$$0.06t = \ln 2$$

$$t = \frac{\ln 2}{0.06} \approx \frac{0.6931}{0.06} \approx 11.55 \text{ years}$$

20. $P(t) = 200e^{0.03t}$

$$\frac{dP}{dt} = 200(0.03)e^{0.03t} = 6e^{0.03t}$$

At $t = 10$:

$$\left. \frac{dP}{dt} \right|_{t=10} = 6e^{0.3} \approx 6(1.3499) \approx 8.10$$

Answer: $\frac{dP}{dt} = 6e^{0.03t}$, and at $t = 10$, the growth rate is ≈ 8.10 people per year.

21. $C(t) = 50e^{-0.5t}$

$$\frac{dC}{dt} = 50(-0.5)e^{-0.5t} = -25e^{-0.5t}$$

At $t = 2$:

$$\left. \frac{dC}{dt} \right|_{t=2} = -25e^{-1} \approx -25(0.3679) \approx -9.20$$

Answer: $\frac{dC}{dt} = -25e^{-0.5t}$, and at $t = 2$, the concentration is decreasing at a rate of approximately 9.20 mg per unit time.

22. $D(t) = 80e^{-0.1t}$, from $t = 0$ to $t = 10$.

Let $u = -0.1t$, $du = -0.1 dt \Rightarrow dt = -10 du$.

$$\int 80e^{-0.1t} dt = 80 \int e^u (-10) du = -800 \int e^u du = -800e^u + C = -800e^{-0.1t} + C$$

Evaluate from 0 to 10:

$$\left[-800e^{-0.1t}\right]_0^{10} = (-800e^{-1}) - (-800e^0) = -800e^{-1} + 800 = 800(1 - e^{-1})$$

$$\approx 800(1 - 0.3679) \approx 800(0.6321) \approx 505.7$$

Answer: total accumulated area = $800(1 - e^{-1}) \approx 505.7$.